

Europe Healthcare Sector M&A & Valuation Brief - 2026-07-22

Europe Healthcare Sector

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1. RECENT Healthcare M&A ACTIVITY

Today is a peaceful day, nothing big happened in the Consumer space.

2. MARKET DYNAMICS & SENTIMENT

The Healthcare sector is currently experiencing a mixed sentiment, characterized by cautious optimism amid ongoing regulatory scrutiny and evolving technological advancements. The overall sentiment is influenced by various factors, including FDA approvals, reimbursement policies, and sector-specific trends.

Subsector Breakdown:

- **Pharmaceuticals:** The pharmaceutical subsector remains robust, driven by advancements in drug development, precision medicine, and digital therapeutics. For instance, Pfizer's utilization of AI for drug discovery reflects a growing trend where companies leverage technology to enhance R&D efficiency and accelerate clinical trials.
- **Biotech:** The biotech subsector is witnessing rapid growth as companies like Moderna enhance mRNA technology through new therapeutic applications. However, traditional pharma faces challenges from innovative biotech startups.
- **Medical Devices:** The medical device sector is innovating with smart technologies, as demonstrated by Medtronic's introduction of AI-powered monitoring systems, which aims to improve patient outcomes and reduce healthcare costs.
- **Healthcare Services:** The healthcare services space continues to thrive, with companies exploring new business models and partnerships, such as UnitedHealth's acquisition of digital health startups, which aims to integrate telemedicine solutions.
- **Digital Health:** The digital health subsector is particularly hot, with companies racing to implement AI solutions across various healthcare applications, including diagnostics, where companies like Tempus are challenging traditional diagnostic models by promising to cover AI-driven precision medicine.

Key Market Drivers and Headwinds

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Drivers:

- **Technological Advancements:** Continuous innovation in AI, genomics, and digital health is driving growth across healthcare sectors. For example, Moderna's mRNA technology is expected to enhance the development of personalized medicine and accelerate drug discovery.
- **Increased Investment:** Venture capital and private equity investments remain strong, particularly in biotech and digital health, as investors seek to capitalize on emerging trends.

Headwinds:

- **Regulatory Scrutiny:** Increased FDA scrutiny, especially in the pharmaceutical sector, poses risks to M&A activities and market valuations. Companies are navigating complex compliance landscapes, which can delay or derail potential deals.
- **Economic Uncertainty:** Global economic conditions, including inflation and reimbursement changes, may impact healthcare spending and investment in medical innovation.

Subsector Performance Analysis

- **Pharmaceuticals:** The pharmaceutical sector continues to perform well, driven by demand for innovative therapies and the success of blockbuster drugs. Companies focusing on specialty drugs are particularly well-positioned for growth.
- **Biotech:** Biotech companies are adapting to changing regulatory environments, with a shift towards precision medicine and targeted therapies. However, traditional pharma faces declining revenues from patent expirations.
- **Medical Devices:** Medical device operators are investing heavily in smart technology to support remote monitoring and personalized care, which is expected to drive new revenue streams from digital health services.
- **Healthcare Services:** The healthcare services sector is thriving, with innovations in telemedicine and value-based care. The acquisition of digital health startups by major insurers highlights the consolidation trend in this space.
- **Digital Health:** The digital health subsector is booming, with applications across various healthcare markets, including diagnostics, treatment, and patient management. Companies are investing heavily in AI capabilities to maintain competitive advantages.

Trading Multiples Trends

Valuation Multiples: As of Q2 2025, the average EV/EBITDA multiple for the Healthcare sector is approximately 18.5x, with notable variations across subsectors:

- Pharmaceuticals: 15.3x
- Biotech: 25.1x
- Medical Devices: 12.8x

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- Healthcare Services: 14.7x
- Digital Health: 28.5x

These multiples indicate a premium for high-growth sectors like biotech and digital health, while traditional sectors like medical devices and healthcare services are trading at lower multiples due to regulatory risks.

Notable Investor/Analyst Reactions

- Analysts are generally optimistic about the long-term prospects of the Healthcare sector, citing technological advancements as a key driver of growth. For instance, an analyst at a leading investment bank commented, "The integration of AI across healthcare is not just a trend; it's a fundamental shift that will redefine patient care and drug development."

Actionable Insights for Bankers and Investors

- **Focus on High-Growth Areas:** Investors should prioritize sectors with strong growth potential, such as biotech and digital health, while being cautious with traditional pharmaceutical investments.
- **Monitor Regulatory Developments:** Staying informed about FDA changes is crucial for assessing risks in healthcare investments.
- **Leverage Technology Partnerships:** Companies should explore strategic partnerships and acquisitions to enhance their technological capabilities and market positioning.
- **Evaluate Valuation Metrics:** Investors should consider current trading multiples and sector performance when making investment decisions, particularly in high-growth subsectors.

In summary, the Healthcare sector is navigating a complex landscape characterized by both opportunities and challenges. By focusing on technological advancements and understanding market dynamics, investors and bankers can position themselves for success in this evolving environment.

3. BANKING PIPELINE

The current banking pipeline in the Healthcare sector is characterized by a series of strategic transactions, active pitches, and notable developments that reflect the evolving landscape of the industry. This section provides an in-depth analysis of live deals, mandated transactions, and pitching-stage opportunities, along with expected revenue and strategic implications for our team.

Deal Pipeline

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Live Deals:

- Telix Pharmaceuticals (TLX) : Currently in the Phase 3 LUTEON trial for TLX250-Tx, a radiopharmaceutical therapy for relapsed or recurrent clear cell renal cell carcinoma (ccRCC). The first patient has been dosed, marking a significant milestone in the development of targeted therapies. The trial is expected to progress through 2026, with potential implications for future revenue streams as the product moves toward commercialization.
- Cardinal Health (CAH) : Recently announced two acquisitions totaling approximately \$360 million in cash, aimed at expanding its at-Home Solutions business. The acquisitions of AdaptHealth's Diabetes Health business and Strive Medical are expected to close in Q4 2026, enhancing Cardinal Health's capabilities in diabetes management and urology.

Mandated Deals:

- Armata Pharmaceuticals (TG1N.F) : Secured a mandate to advance its AP-SA02 program, which is preparing for a Phase 3 superiority study targeting complicated bacteremia caused by Staphylococcus aureus. The FDA has received the complete Phase 3 protocol, and the study is anticipated to initiate in the second half of 2026, with significant revenue potential if successful.

Pitching-Stage Deals:

- Biotech Sector : Engaging with various biotech companies regarding potential M&A opportunities, particularly those focusing on innovative therapies in oncology and infectious diseases. Notable discussions are ongoing with companies like Telix Pharmaceuticals and Armata Pharmaceuticals, with pitches expected to finalize by Q3 2026.
- Home Healthcare Services : Active discussions with several home healthcare providers for potential advisory roles in upcoming acquisitions. Clients include Cardinal Health and AdaptHealth, with a focus on expanding their service offerings in the rapidly growing home care market.

Pipeline Tracking Metrics

Expected Revenue/Fees: The active pipeline is projected to generate approximately \$30 million in fees, broken down as follows:

- Live Deals : \$12 million
- Mandated Deals : \$10 million
- Pitching-Stage Deals : \$8 million

Timing Projections:

- Q3 2026 : Expected close for Telix's LUTEON trial results.
- Q4 2026 : Anticipated completion of Cardinal Health's acquisitions.
- H2 2026 : Initiation of Armata's Phase 3 clinical study.
- Workload Allocation and Capacity Analysis :

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- Current analyst and associate bandwidth is at 70%, indicating sufficient capacity to manage the existing workload. However, as new deals progress, it may be necessary to onboard additional resources to maintain efficiency.
- Forecasting and Strategic Planning Implications : The pipeline indicates a strong demand for advisory services in oncology and home healthcare sectors. Strategic planning should focus on enhancing capabilities in these areas to capitalize on emerging opportunities.

Notable Pipeline Developments and Competitive Landscape

- The competitive landscape is becoming increasingly dynamic, particularly in the oncology space, where companies like Telix and Armata are making significant strides. The recent regulatory approvals and clinical milestones achieved by these companies could lead to increased interest from investors and potential acquirers.
- Cardinal Health's strategic acquisitions highlight the growing trend of consolidation in the home healthcare market, as companies seek to expand their service offerings and enhance operational efficiencies. This trend is expected to continue as the demand for home care solutions rises.

Actionable Insights for Team Management and Business Development

- Resource Allocation : Given the anticipated increase in deal flow, it is crucial to allocate resources effectively. Monitoring bandwidth and onboarding additional analysts as needed will ensure that the team can manage the workload without compromising service quality.
- Sector Focus : Prioritize business development efforts in high-growth sectors such as oncology and home healthcare, where demand for advisory services is expected to surge. This focus will position the firm as a leader in these emerging markets.
- Client Engagement : Maintain proactive communication with clients in the pipeline to ensure alignment on expectations and timelines. Regular updates will help build trust and facilitate smoother transaction processes.

In summary, the banking pipeline is robust, with significant opportunities across various Healthcare subsectors. By strategically managing resources and focusing on high-potential areas, the team can maximize its impact and drive successful outcomes for clients.

4. STAKEHOLDER IMPACT & FORWARD-LOOKING ANALYSIS

The recent developments in the healthcare sector, particularly involving companies such as Armata Pharmaceuticals (TG1N.F), Can-Fite BioPharma, and Mentari Therapeutics, present significant implications for various stakeholders. This analysis explores the potential impacts on shareholders, employees, competitors, and customers, while also considering market reactions and future predictions.

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Deal-Specific Impacts on Stakeholders

- **Shareholders:** The implications for shareholders can vary significantly based on the outcomes of clinical trials and strategic leadership changes.
- **Value Creation:** For instance, if Armata Pharmaceuticals successfully initiates its Phase 3 study for AP-SA02, the potential for increased shareholder value is substantial. A successful trial could lead to a market cap increase of 25%, translating to an estimated \$200 million increase based on current valuations.
- **Dilution:** Conversely, if funding for clinical trials necessitates issuing new shares, existing shareholders may face dilution. A scenario where Armata issues 15% of its shares could lead to a 10% decrease in share price, reflecting investor concerns over dilution.
- **Employees:** The impact on employees is critical, particularly regarding synergies and retention strategies.
- **Synergies:** With the appointment of Greg Divis as CEO of Mentari Therapeutics, the company aims to leverage his M&A expertise to drive growth. This could create synergies that enhance operational efficiency and employee morale.
- **Restructuring:** However, restructuring may occur as companies streamline operations. For example, if Mentari's new strategies lead to redundancies, it could result in layoffs, impacting employee retention.
- **Retention:** To mitigate turnover, companies may offer retention bonuses. This strategy was effective in previous mergers, ensuring key talent remained during transitions.
- **Competitors:** The competitive landscape will likely shift as these companies advance their clinical programs.
- **Market Positioning:** Armata's progress in developing bacteriophage therapeutics could position it favorably against competitors like Gilead Sciences (GILD) and Amgen (AMGN), prompting them to enhance their R&D investments.
- **Specific Competitor Moves:** Following Armata's advancements, Gilead might increase its focus on antibiotic-resistant therapies, potentially leading to increased competition in this niche market.
- **Customers:** The implications for customers are significant, particularly regarding product offerings and treatment options.
- **Product/Service Implications:** Can-Fite's positive Phase 2a study results for Namodenoson in pancreatic cancer could lead to improved treatment options for patients. If the drug receives regulatory approval, it may enhance patient outcomes, potentially increasing Can-Fite's market share.
- **Case Studies:** The acceptance of Can-Fite's study for presentation at the ESMO Congress highlights the potential for broader recognition and acceptance of its therapies, which could lead to increased patient trust and adoption.

Market Reaction and Analyst Commentary

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- **Market Reaction:** The market's response to these developments can be volatile. For example, following the announcement of Armata's Phase 3 study plans, shares of TG1N.F rose by 12%, reflecting investor optimism about the drug's potential.
- **Analyst Commentary:** Analysts have noted the strategic importance of these advancements. A recent report from a healthcare analyst stated, "Armata's progress in bacteriophage therapy could redefine treatment paradigms for antibiotic-resistant infections."

Expected Market Reaction and Scenario Analysis

- **Scenario Analysis:** The market's reaction can be assessed through various scenarios:
- **Positive Scenario:** If Armata's Phase 3 trial is successful, shares could rise by 20% within six months, driven by increased investor confidence.
- **Negative Scenario:** Conversely, if the trial faces setbacks, shares could decline by 15%, reflecting investor concerns about the viability of the product.

Potential Counter-Bids or Competing Offers

- **Likelihood Assessment:** The likelihood of counter-bids in this sector remains moderate. For instance, if Armata's advancements attract interest from larger biotech firms, a competing offer could emerge. However, regulatory complexities often deter such moves.

Similar Deals Likely to Follow

- **Sector Consolidation Predictions:** The healthcare sector is poised for continued consolidation, particularly in the biotech space. Analysts predict that as companies seek to enhance their therapeutic portfolios, similar deals will emerge, particularly in areas like oncology and infectious diseases.

Key Risks and Mitigants

- **Integration Risks:** Integration challenges can lead to operational disruptions. Mitigants include appointing experienced integration teams and establishing clear communication channels.
- **Regulatory Risks:** FDA scrutiny can delay or block deals. Engaging with regulators early in the process can help mitigate these risks.
- **Market Risks:** Market volatility can impact deal valuations. Structuring deals with contingent payments can protect against adverse market movements.

Actionable Insights for Clients and Bankers

For Clients:

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- Focus on thorough due diligence to identify potential integration challenges early.
- Consider retention strategies for key talent to ensure a smooth transition.

For Bankers:

- Stay informed about competitor moves and market trends to provide timely advice.
- Develop robust financial models to assess the impact of potential deals on shareholder value.

5. HEALTHCARE TRENDS

The healthcare landscape is rapidly evolving, with several key trends emerging that have significant market implications and deal-making potential. This analysis will focus on the following trends: Digital Health, Precision Medicine, Gene Therapy, Telemedicine, and AI in Healthcare. Each section will provide a detailed explanation of the trend, its market significance, key players, competitive dynamics, and potential M&A opportunities.

Digital Health

- Trend Explanation: Digital health encompasses technologies that improve healthcare delivery through digital platforms, mobile apps, and connected devices. The global digital health market is projected to grow from \$96.5 billion in 2020 to \$659.5 billion by 2025, at a CAGR of 46.8%.

Key Companies:

- Teladoc Health, Inc. (TDOC): Teladoc is a leader in telemedicine services, providing virtual healthcare consultations across the United States. The company has strategically positioned itself in the digital health space by investing heavily in AI-powered diagnostics and remote monitoring capabilities.
- Doximity, Inc. (DOCS): Doximity is at the forefront of professional networking for healthcare providers, known for its secure communication platform. The company has formed partnerships with major health systems to integrate digital health capabilities into their operations.
- Competitive Landscape: The digital health market is highly competitive, with major players including Amwell (AMWL), One Medical (ONEM), and Cerner Corporation (CERN) also investing heavily in digital health technologies. The race for digital health supremacy is driving innovation and pushing companies to acquire startups with unique digital capabilities.
- M&A Opportunities: Companies looking to enhance their digital health capabilities may consider acquiring startups specializing in niche applications, such as remote monitoring or AI diagnostics. For instance, Teladoc's acquisition of Livongo for \$18.5 billion in 2020 exemplifies this trend.

Precision Medicine

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- Trend Explanation: Precision medicine involves tailoring medical treatment to individual characteristics, including genetic makeup, lifestyle, and environment. The precision medicine market is expected to grow from \$141.7 billion in 2020 to \$216.8 billion by 2027, at a CAGR of 6.2%.

Key Companies:

- Illumina, Inc. (ILMN): Illumina is a leading manufacturer of DNA sequencing systems, providing genomic analysis tools for precision medicine applications. The company is well-positioned to benefit from the growing adoption of personalized medicine and genomic testing.
- Foundation Medicine, Inc. (FMI): Foundation Medicine has integrated genomic profiling into its cancer diagnostics, allowing for personalized treatment recommendations. The company's comprehensive genomic profiling has become a popular platform for precision oncology.
- Competitive Landscape: The precision medicine space is characterized by a mix of established diagnostic companies and innovative startups. Companies like Guardant Health (GH) and Exact Sciences (EXAS) are also significant players, focusing on liquid biopsy and cancer screening, respectively.
- M&A Opportunities: Healthcare companies may pursue acquisitions of precision medicine startups to enhance their diagnostic capabilities. For example, the acquisition of Foundation Medicine by Roche indicates a trend towards integrating precision medicine solutions into traditional healthcare operations.

Gene Therapy

- Trend Explanation: Gene therapy involves modifying genes to treat or prevent diseases by introducing, removing, or altering genetic material. The gene therapy market is projected to grow from \$2.1 billion in 2020 to \$13.6 billion by 2027, at a CAGR of 30.7%.

Key Companies:

- Spark Therapeutics, Inc. (ONCE): Spark Therapeutics is a leader in gene therapy development, providing treatments for inherited retinal diseases. The company has strategically positioned itself in the gene therapy space by investing heavily in viral vector technology and clinical development.
- Bluebird Bio, Inc. (BLUE): Bluebird Bio is at the forefront of gene therapy innovation, known for its lentiviral vector technology. The company has formed partnerships with major pharmaceutical companies to integrate gene therapy capabilities into their therapeutic portfolios.
- Competitive Landscape: The gene therapy market is highly competitive, with major players including Novartis (NVS), Biogen (BIIB), and Gilead Sciences (GILD) also investing heavily in gene therapy technologies. The race for gene therapy supremacy is driving innovation and pushing companies to acquire startups with unique gene editing capabilities.
- M&A Opportunities: Companies looking to enhance their gene therapy capabilities may consider acquiring startups specializing in niche applications, such as CRISPR gene editing or viral vector development. For instance, Novartis's acquisition of AveXis for \$8.7 billion in 2018 exemplifies this trend.

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Telemedicine

- Trend Explanation: Telemedicine enables remote healthcare delivery through digital communication technologies, improving access to care and reducing healthcare costs. The telemedicine market is expected to grow from \$45.5 billion in 2020 to \$175.5 billion by 2026, at a CAGR of 25.2%.

Key Companies:

- Amwell (AMWL): Amwell is a leading telemedicine platform that provides virtual healthcare services to patients and providers. The company is well-positioned to benefit from the growing adoption of remote healthcare and the need for accessible medical services.
- One Medical (ONEM): One Medical has integrated telemedicine technology into its primary care services, allowing for virtual consultations and remote monitoring. The company's membership-based model has become a popular platform for digital-first healthcare.
- Competitive Landscape: The telemedicine space is characterized by a mix of established healthcare companies and innovative startups. Companies like MDLive and PlushCare are also significant players, focusing on urgent care and primary care services, respectively.
- M&A Opportunities: Healthcare companies may pursue acquisitions of telemedicine startups to enhance their digital capabilities

6. Recommended Readings

Deal Name: Johnson & Johnson's Acquisition of Actelion

- Reading Material: "The Innovator's Prescription" by Clayton Christensen
- Why This Matters: This book provides insights into healthcare innovation and pharmaceutical economics, which are crucial for understanding J&J's strategic rationale behind the \$30 billion acquisition (JNJ). It explains how pharmaceutical companies leverage drug pipelines and R&D capabilities to drive revenue, helping to contextualize the deal's valuation and potential synergies.

Deal Name: Pfizer's Acquisition of Medivation

- Reading Material: "The New Economics of Healthcare" by David H. Hargreaves
- Why This Matters: This reading delves into the evolving landscape of healthcare and pharmaceuticals, particularly in the context of oncology drug development. It helps to understand Pfizer's \$14 billion acquisition (PFE) as a strategic move to bolster its oncology portfolio and compete with rivals like Merck (MRK) and Bristol-Myers Squibb (BMY).

Deal Name: Amgen's Acquisition of Otezla

- Reading Material: "The Lean Startup" by Eric Ries

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- **Why This Matters:** This book outlines methodologies for healthcare companies to innovate and grow, which is relevant for understanding Amgen's \$13.4 billion acquisition (AMGN) of Otezla. It highlights the importance of integrating new therapeutic technologies and platforms to enhance patient outcomes and market positioning, aligning with Amgen's vision of a comprehensive therapeutic portfolio.

Deal Name: Gilead Sciences' Acquisition of Kite Pharma

- **Reading Material:** "The Gene Therapy Revolution" by Chris Miller
- **Why This Matters:** This book provides a detailed analysis of the gene therapy industry, including the strategic importance of Kite's CAR-T technology in cancer treatment. Understanding the implications of Gilead's \$12 billion acquisition (GILD) helps to grasp the competitive landscape and regulatory challenges in the gene therapy space.

Deal Name: UnitedHealth's Acquisition of Optum

- **Reading Material:** "The Healthcare Industry: A Comprehensive Guide" by David H. Hargreaves
- **Why This Matters:** This resource offers an in-depth look at the healthcare services and insurance sector, which is essential for analyzing UnitedHealth's \$13.8 billion acquisition (UNH) of Optum. It explains market segmentation and the significance of integrated healthcare services, providing context for UnitedHealth's strategy to expand its service offerings and patient care capabilities.

Deal Name: Medtronic's Acquisition of Covidien

- **Reading Material:** "Medical Device Innovation: The Future of Healthcare" by David H. Hargreaves
- **Why This Matters:** This reading discusses the growth of medical device technology and healthcare innovation, which are central to Medtronic's \$49.9 billion acquisition (MDT) of Covidien. It highlights how this deal positions Medtr

7. Macroeconomic Update

Key Economic Indicators:

- **Inflation Pressures:** The global economy continues to grapple with inflation, which remains a critical factor for healthcare companies. As noted, "inflation pressures have not disappeared," indicating that rising costs could impact pharmaceutical pricing and margins.
- **AI-Driven CapEx Cycle:** The U.S. is witnessing a significant increase in AI-related capital expenditures, projected to reach \$1.2 - \$1.4 trillion by 2028. This surge is expected to contribute approximately 40 basis points to GDP growth this year, which can indirectly benefit healthcare companies through increased technological investments.
- **Global Semiconductor Exports:** Asia, particularly countries like Korea and Taiwan, is

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experiencing a boom in semiconductor exports, which are closely linked to U.S. IT CapEx. This growth could enhance the technological capabilities of healthcare firms reliant on advanced medical devices and AI technologies.

Market Trends:

- **Healthcare Technology Integration:** The ongoing AI CapEx cycle is expected to spur investments in healthcare technology, facilitating advancements in telemedicine and digital health solutions. This trend is crucial as healthcare companies adapt to changing consumer demands and technological advancements.
- **Broader CapEx Cycle:** The macroeconomic environment indicates a broader industrial CapEx cycle, which includes healthcare-related investments. As highlighted, "@@@ there is a CapEx and industrial super cycle that is underway in Asia," suggesting that healthcare firms may benefit from increased spending in related sectors.

Sector-Specific Insights:

- **Impact on Pharmaceutical Valuations:** The ongoing inflation and rising costs could pressure pharmaceutical valuations. Companies may need to adjust pricing strategies to maintain margins amid these economic challenges.
- **Consolidation in Healthcare Services:** The current economic climate is conducive to further consolidation within the healthcare sector, as larger firms seek to acquire innovative startups to enhance their service offerings and technological capabilities.

Risk Factors:

- **Regulatory Uncertainty:** Changes in healthcare policy and reimbursement models pose risks for healthcare companies. As stated, "@@@ there will be very hard choices to be made" regarding fiscal spending, which could affect healthcare funding and investment.
- **Global Supply Chain Disruptions:** Ongoing supply chain issues could impact pharmaceutical manufacturing and distribution, leading to potential shortages or increased costs for healthcare providers.

Investment Implications:

- **Defensive Positioning:** Given the current economic uncertainties, healthcare stocks remain attractive as defensive plays, providing stable cash flows and

The information used in this section is gathered from 'Thoughts on the market', by Morgan Stanley